FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731

REPORT

Submitted by

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in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

IN

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND DESIGN



RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

SEPTEMBER 2026

RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

CHENNAI

BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

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CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that brings together storytelling, acting, cinematography, lighting, sound and editing in order to communicate an idea or an emotion to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, which makes it necessary to develop a clear concept and to use every shot, sound and pause with purpose. Radio podcasting, in contrast, tells stories entirely through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms depend on imagination, careful planning and a strong understanding of the audience.

Visual storytelling is important because human beings understand the world largely through what they see. A carefully framed image, a change in light or a small movement on the screen can communicate meaning without a single word of dialogue. Modern audiences, who spend a large part of their day looking at screens, respond quickly to visual cues, and a filmmaker can use this habit to guide attention, create expectations and, when required, deliberately mislead them.

The psychological thriller is one of the most effective genres for exploring this relationship between perception and reality. Unlike conventional horror, which often relies on a visible monster or a violent event, a psychological thriller places the source of fear inside the mind of the character. The audience is asked to question what is real, what is imagined and whether the character can trust her own senses. The tension therefore grows from uncertainty rather than from spectacle.

The project titled “VISUAL ANOMALY” is a psychological thriller and horror short film with a running time of three minutes and fifteen seconds. It follows a young working woman who returns to her apartment after a long day and begins to receive frightening messages from an unknown sender. The messages appear to know exactly what she is doing and seeing, and her fear grows with every notification. The film ultimately reveals that no message was ever real, because the phone was never in her hand. The central concept of the project is the conflict between hallucination and reality.

The story is also designed so that it can be adapted into a radio podcast. In the audio version, notifications, breathing, silence and narration replace the visual elements, demonstrating how the same idea can be experienced through a different medium.

CHAPTER 2
PROJECT OVERVIEW

The purpose of VISUAL ANOMALY is to apply the principles learned in the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course to an original short film. The project brings together screenplay writing, direction, acting, camera work, lighting, sound design and editing in a single production. Its central aim is to show that a strong psychological experience can be created with a simple idea, limited resources and a carefully controlled cinematic language.

A single-location thriller was chosen because it is practical for a small student production and because confinement strengthens the emotional effect of the story. The entire film takes place inside one apartment, moving from the living room to the bedroom. Since the protagonist never leaves the space, the audience shares her isolation and feels that there is no escape. A single location also reduces logistical problems such as travel, permissions and continuity, allowing more time to be given to performance, framing and sound.

The film demonstrates how ordinary situations can become frightening. Returning home, switching on the lights and checking a phone are actions that every viewer performs daily and associates with safety. By beginning with such familiar behaviour, the film builds trust with the audience. When a simple notification then disturbs this comfort, the fear feels personal, because the viewer recognises the situation as something that could happen in real life.

The key details of the project are summarised below.

- **Title:** Visual Anomaly
- **Genre:** Psychological Thriller / Horror
- **Duration:** 2 minutes 15 seconds
- **Main character:** A young working woman
- **Theme:** Hallucination, paranoia, fear and distorted reality
- **Tagline:** The phone was never there. The fear always was.

The intended audience reaction follows a clear progression. The viewer should first feel suspense as the messages begin, then confusion as the messages seem to describe the woman's

private actions, and finally shock when the reveal shows that the entire threat existed only in her mind.

CHAPTER 3
TITLE – VISUAL ANOMALY

The title “VISUAL ANOMALY” has been selected because it summarises the central idea of the film in two words. Each word carries a meaning that becomes clear only when the story is understood completely.

The word “Visual” refers to perception, that is, the act of seeing and interpreting the world. In a film, the audience depends on what the camera shows, and in life, a person depends on what the eyes and brain report. The protagonist trusts what she sees on her phone screen without questioning it. Her entire experience is built upon visual information that appears reliable.

The word “Anomaly” means something abnormal, irregular or different from what is expected. In this story, the anomaly is not a ghost, an intruder or a supernatural event. It is a fault in perception. The notifications that appear on the screen are irregularities produced by the character’s own mind, and they disturb the normal order of her reality.

Together, the two words describe the experience of seeing things that do not actually exist. The title symbolises the protagonist’s distorted reality, in which imagination and fear take the form of text messages that she believes are real. It also prepares the audience for a story about mistrusting the senses, without revealing the ending.

The title also carries a second meaning for the audience. Viewers watching the film are themselves guided to see the same false notifications as the woman. They are therefore placed inside the anomaly and experience the deception directly, which makes the final reveal more effective. The title works both as a description of the character’s condition and as a comment on how cinema controls what viewers believe they see.

The tagline, “The phone was never there. The fear always was,” supports the title by emphasising that the danger was imaginary while the emotion was completely genuine.

CHAPTER 4
GENRE

VISUAL ANOMALY belongs to the psychological thriller and horror genre. A psychological thriller focuses on the mental and emotional state of its characters and creates tension through doubt, fear and uncertainty. The following elements are central to this film.

- **Suspense:** information is released slowly, and each message raises a new question before the previous one is answered.
- **Paranoia:** the protagonist begins to believe that she is being watched and that every action is known to someone else.
- **Isolation:** she is alone in her apartment, with no one to verify her experience or to offer reassurance.
- **Hallucination:** the notifications are created by her mind, which blurs the boundary between what is real and what is imagined.
- **Fear without a physical villain:** no attacker is ever shown, and the threat exists only in her perception.

The absence of a visible villain is the most important feature of the genre in this project. When the source of fear is not shown, each viewer fills the empty space with a personal fear, which is often more disturbing than any image the filmmaker could create. The empty apartment becomes threatening precisely because nothing is present in it.

The major suspense elements used in the film are:

- Phone notifications
- Silence
- Curtains
- Empty house
- Bedroom
- Breathing
- Unknown messages
- Final reveal

These elements are ordinary, and this is the reason they work. Curtains, a bedroom and a phone are objects from everyday life, but under the influence of paranoia they become symbols of surveillance and danger.

CHAPTER 5
OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging psychological thriller short film using a simple production setup and basic filmmaking techniques. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera language, lighting, sound and editing can be combined to shape the emotional response of an audience, and how the same story can be translated into a radio format.

The specific objectives of the project are as follows:

- To develop an original psychological thriller with a clear beginning, middle and unexpected ending.
- To learn screenplay writing and to structure a story within a very short running time of 3 minutes 15 seconds.
- To create suspense through camera language, including framing, angles and camera movement.
- To practise lighting techniques that convey a change from comfort to fear.
- To improve sound design by using silence, ambience and effects to build tension.
- To use editing to manipulate the perception and expectations of the audience.
- To design notification graphics and on-screen text that appear believable.
- To understand how to portray fear and paranoia through acting and body language.
- To explore the themes of hallucination, mental health and distorted reality responsibly.
- To adapt the visual story into an audio format and understand the difference between visual and audio storytelling.

Achieving these objectives gives the student practical experience in every stage of production, from the first idea to the exported film. It also encourages a critical understanding of how each creative decision affects the audience, which is the essential skill of a filmmaker.

CHAPTER 6
STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story of VISUAL ANOMALY developed from a simple question: what would be the most frightening thing to see on a phone when returning home alone? The idea began with the common human fear of being watched. Most people have experienced the sudden feeling that someone is observing them when they are alone in a quiet room, even when nothing supports the feeling. This instinct became the emotional foundation of the film.

The next stage of development was inspired by the way hallucinations and paranoia can affect perception. A person experiencing intense stress or fear may see, hear or feel things that are not present, yet those experiences appear entirely real to that person. The filmmaker decided to present such an experience from the inside, so that the audience would believe the hallucination in the same way the protagonist does.

The mobile phone was chosen as the central object because it is the most personal device in modern life. It carries messages, locations and private information, and people trust it without hesitation. A message from an unknown sender that seems to describe her private actions feels intrusive, and the phone therefore becomes a believable channel through which fear can enter her home. The phone also allows the story to be told with minimal dialogue, since the frightening voice appears only as text.

The twist works only at the ending because the entire structure depends on withholding one fact. If the audience learned early that the woman was not holding a phone, the tension would disappear. The film therefore never shows her hand clearly holding the device, and every notification is presented as if it were real. The reveal under the bed reinterprets everything that came before.

Misleading the audience is a deliberate technique and is central to the project. The audience is given only what the protagonist believes, and the film trusts that viewers will accept it. This

creates the shock at the ending, and it also carries a message: fear can be convincing enough to replace reality.

CHAPTER 7
STORY SYNOPSIS

The film begins with a young woman returning to her apartment after a long and tiring day at work. She unlocks the door, enters the living room and puts down her handbag and keys. She switches on the lights, and the warm glow fills the room. The place is quiet and familiar, and she relaxes on the sofa, releasing the tension of the day.

Her calm is broken when her phone appears to receive a notification. The message reads, “You’re finally home.” She is confused, because she has just arrived and has told nobody. She looks around the empty apartment, but nothing appears out of place. Fear slowly replaces her confusion, and she begins to believe that someone is stalking her. She asks herself who could possibly know that she had just come home.

While thinking about this, she notices that the curtains are open. The realisation that anyone outside could have been watching her makes her uneasy, and she immediately walks across the room and closes them. She thinks that the danger has been shut out, but another notification appears: “Why did you close the curtains?” The message proves to her that the sender is observing her actions at that very moment.

Now convinced that someone is watching from outside, she hurries into her bedroom. Her breathing becomes heavier as she scans the room and tries to find a safe place. The bedroom is darker, and the shadows in the corners make the space seem larger and more threatening. Suddenly another message appears: “Don’t look left.”

Instinctively, she turns her head to the left. Nothing is there, but the reaction confirms her loss of control. A new message arrives immediately: “I told you not to look left.” Her panic reaches its peak, and she stands motionless with her breath shaking. The sender seems to see her, to command her and to anticipate her every move.

The final notification instructs her: “Look under the bed.” Slowly, and with obvious fear, she kneels beside the bed and lowers her head to look underneath. There, lying on the floor in the dust and shadow, is her own phone.

At this moment the audience realises the truth. She never had a phone in her hand, and every notification was a hallucination created by her own mind. The screen fades to black, and the

quote appears: “The scariest prison is the one your mind builds.” It is followed by the closing line: “The phone was never there. The fear always was.”

CHAPTER 8
CHARACTERS

Character 1: The Woman

The protagonist is a young working woman of around twenty-six years. She works in an office job that demands long hours, and she lives alone in a small apartment in a large city. Her occupation and lifestyle are intentionally ordinary so that viewers can identify with her. At the start of the film she is tired, quiet and relieved to be home.

By nature she is responsible, observant and cautious, but also mentally exhausted by work and solitude. These qualities make her vulnerable to anxiety. Her carefulness, which is normally an advantage, becomes the reason she believes the messages so quickly and reacts so strongly to them.

Her emotional transformation is the emotional centre of the film. She begins in a state of relaxation, moves to confusion when the first message arrives, and then to suspicion and paranoia when she thinks she is watched. In the bedroom she reaches terror, and at the end she is left in shock and disbelief when she understands what has happened. The actor must express these changes through breathing, posture, eye movement and minimal dialogue.

Her internal conflict is between rational thought and fear. A part of her mind wants to believe that the messages are a mistake or a joke, while another part is certain that she is being observed. She obeys the messages even while doubting them, which shows that fear has begun to control her decisions.

Character 2: The Hallucination

The second character is not a real person. The hallucination is the manifestation of the woman's fear inside her own mind, and it appears only as text on a phone that does not exist. It has no face, no voice and no body, and the audience never sees an intruder. Its power comes from the fact that it knows what she does because it is part of her.

Its messages are short and commanding, and they follow her actions closely. In this way it acts like a reflection of her anxiety, giving form to what she already fears. Because it cannot be

arrested, fought or escaped, it represents the most difficult enemy a person can face: their own mind.

CHAPTER 9
SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – Entering Home

Location: Apartment door and living room

Camera Mood: Calm, steady and observational, using wide and medium shots

Purpose: Establish normal life and the character's routine.

The scene opens with the woman unlocking the door of her apartment after a long working day. She steps inside, places her handbag and house keys on a table and switches on the lights. The camera remains still and slightly distant so that the audience can observe the room and the character without pressure. The warm light, the ordinary sounds of the light switch and footsteps, and her tired but relaxed movements create a feeling of safety. This comfort is important because the later scenes depend on the contrast with it.

9.2 Scene 2 – First Message

Location: Living room, sofa area

Camera Mood: Close and intimate, with a gradual push-in on her face

Purpose: Introduce mystery and the first doubt.

The woman sits on the sofa and begins to relax. A notification tone sounds, and the words "You're finally home." appear on the screen. The camera moves closer to her face to capture confusion, and a graphic of the message is shown. She stands up and looks around the empty room. The scene introduces the central question of the film, who knows that she has just arrived, and the mood shifts from comfort to unease without any physical event taking place.

9.3 Scene 3 – The Curtains

Location: Living room, window area
Camera Mood: Tense and controlled, with static framing and quick reaction cuts
Purpose: Create the feeling of being watched.

Thinking about who could know her movements, the woman notices that the curtains are open and that the dark window reflects the room. She walks quickly to the window and closes the curtains. The camera watches from a fixed position so that the space feels observed. A second notification then appears: “Why did you close the curtains?” The message convinces her that someone is outside. This scene turns simple confusion into full paranoia and gives the audience an early sense of surveillance.

9.4 Scene 4 – Entering the Bedroom

Location: Corridor and bedroom
Camera Mood: Handheld and restless, with a low, unstable perspective
Purpose: Show her attempt to escape and raise the level of fear.

Believing that the danger is close, she rushes into her bedroom. Her breathing becomes heavier and the sound of her footsteps grows faster. The camera follows her closely with slight movement to reflect her anxiety, and the lighting becomes noticeably dimmer. She scans the room, checking the corners, the wardrobe and the window. The bedroom is meant to be a private and secure space, but here it becomes a trap, which increases the psychological pressure on the character.

9.5 Scene 5 – Don’t Look Left

Location: Bedroom, near the bed

Camera Mood: Extremely tight and uncomfortable, using close-ups and a subject-view perspective

Purpose: Demonstrate control over the character and reach the point of panic.

A new message appears: “Don’t look left.” Almost involuntarily, she turns her head to the left and the camera turns with her, showing an empty corner of the room. A second message immediately follows: “I told you not to look left.” The audience recognises that the sender appears to see her, and her panic reaches its peak. The scene uses very little movement and long pauses so that the viewer feels trapped in the same moment as the character.

9.6 Scene 6 – Look Under the Bed

Location: Bedroom, beside the bed

Camera Mood: Slow, deliberate and low, with the camera moving down with her

Purpose: Build the final suspense before the reveal.

The last notification commands her: “Look under the bed.” The room becomes almost silent. She kneels slowly, her hands trembling, and the camera sinks to floor level. The scene delays the reveal by showing her face, her hand on the mattress and the dark gap beneath the bed. This delay is deliberate, because the longer the audience waits, the stronger the eventual shock becomes.

9.7 Scene 7 – Final Reveal

Location: Bedroom floor, followed by a black screen

Camera Mood: Still and cold, with a quiet close-up of the object

Purpose: Reveal the truth and end the film with a message.

She lowers her head and looks under the bed. On the floor, in the dust and darkness, lies her own phone. The camera holds on the device for a moment so that the audience understands that she never had it in her hand and that every message was imagined. The image fades to black, and the final quote and tagline appear on the screen. The scene reinterprets the entire film and leaves the audience with a lasting impression.

Summary of Scenes

Scene	Title	Location	Purpose
1	Entering Home	Living room	Establish normal life
2	First Message	Living room	Introduce mystery
3	The Curtains	Living room	Create paranoia
4	Entering the Bedroom	Bedroom	Escalate fear
5	Don’t Look Left	Bedroom	Show loss of control
6	Look Under the Bed	Bedroom	Build final suspense
7	Final Reveal	Bedroom	Reveal the truth

The seven scenes follow a rising pattern of tension. The first two establish safety and disturb it, the middle scenes escalate the fear through surveillance and confinement, and the final scene resolves the mystery with a psychological reveal.

CHAPTER 10
CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax of VISUAL ANOMALY occurs when the woman kneels beside the bed and looks underneath it. Every earlier message has led to this instruction, and the audience expects to see the person who has been watching her. The camera follows her slowly downward, and the silence in the room becomes almost unbearable.

The discovery of the phone is the turning point of the film. On the floor beneath the bed lies her own phone, silent and untouched. The audience realises that she never had a phone in her hand and that every notification she read existed only in her mind. The shock comes from the reinterpretation of every earlier scene, because each message the viewer trusted is now revealed as a hallucination.

This twist carries a clear meaning. The threat was never outside the apartment, behind the curtains or in the corner of the bedroom. It was inside her own thoughts, where fear had grown strong enough to create a convincing reality. The sender of the messages and the victim were the same person.

The ending is psychological rather than supernatural because no ghost, intruder or unexplained force is introduced. The film keeps its rules consistent: everything the audience experienced was a product of perception. This makes the ending more disturbing for many viewers, because a supernatural threat can be dismissed as fiction, while a mind that deceives itself is a real possibility. It also allows the film to comment on paranoia, anxiety and the fragile line between imagination and truth.

The film closes with a fade to black, followed by the final quote:

"The scariest prison is the one your mind builds."

A final line then appears as the tagline of the film: “The phone was never there. The fear always was.”

CHAPTER 11
CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography controls how the audience sees the story, and in a film about distorted perception it is especially important. The camera language of VISUAL ANOMALY moves from open and stable in the beginning to close and confined at the end, reflecting the narrowing of the character's mental world.

- **Wide shots:** used in the opening to show the apartment and to make the woman appear small in the space. They establish the location and later emphasise emptiness and isolation.
- **Medium shots:** used for everyday actions such as sitting, walking and closing the curtains. They keep the character and her surroundings visible and give a realistic tone.
- **Close-ups:** used for her eyes, breathing, hands and the phone screen. They reveal emotion and allow the audience to read the messages clearly.
- **POV shots:** used when she scans the room or looks left. The audience sees what she sees and therefore shares her paranoia.
- **Over-the-shoulder shots:** used when she reads notifications and looks around, creating the feeling that someone may also be watching from behind.
- **Slow push-ins:** used at the first message and before the reveal to increase pressure gradually and to focus attention on her reaction.
- **Static framing:** used during moments of dread, such as at the curtains. A fixed camera makes the audience feel that an unseen observer is watching.

The overall approach is to keep the camera simple and purposeful. Restrained movement, combined with careful framing, allows the tension to grow naturally and prevents the visuals from distracting from the psychological story.

CHAPTER 12
LIGHTING

Lighting tells the emotional story of the film alongside the action. The design follows a clear progression from warmth to darkness, matching the change in the woman's state of mind.

Beginning – Warm Indoor Lighting

When the woman enters the apartment and switches on the lights, the room is filled with soft, warm illumination. Yellow tones and gentle shadows suggest comfort and safety. This look establishes a sense of home and relaxation, which the audience will later associate with what has been lost.

Middle – Dimmer Atmosphere

After the first notifications, the atmosphere becomes dimmer. The contrast increases, and the corners of the room fall into shadow. The curtains, which are drawn closed, reduce the natural light and make the space feel enclosed. The change is gradual so that the audience feels the mood alter without noticing a sudden shift.

Bedroom – Directional Light

In the bedroom, a single directional source, such as a bedside lamp or a low side light, is used. It illuminates part of her face and leaves the rest of the frame dark. This creates strong contrast and a feeling of exposure, as if she were being observed. The phone screen adds a cold blue light on her face during the messages, which contrasts with the warm tone of the earlier scenes.

Ending – Shadows Dominating the Frame

In the final scenes, shadows dominate the frame. The space under the bed is very dark, and the light falls only on her hands and part of her face. The phone lying in the shadow is revealed by a narrow strip of light. The dark frame is finally replaced by a complete fade to black, so the visual design of the film ends in the same way as the story: with the loss of clarity.

CHAPTER 13
SOUND DESIGN

Sound is essential to VISUAL ANOMALY because the fear is not visible. The audience must feel the threat through what it hears, and the design therefore uses realistic sounds that are gradually distorted.

- **Light switch:** a sharp, clear click at the start that establishes the realistic environment.
- **Footsteps:** steady and relaxed at first, then faster and lighter as her fear increases.
- **Phone vibration:** a short buzz that prepares the audience for each message.
- **Notification tone:** a soft, ordinary chime that becomes threatening through repetition.
- **Breathing:** close and gradually heavier, becoming the main emotional sound in the bedroom.
- **Silence:** used deliberately before and after important events.
- **Low-frequency ambience:** a barely audible hum that produces unease without being noticed consciously.
- **Heartbeat effect:** a soft pulse that rises before the final reveal.
- **Final silence:** the complete removal of sound after the last line appears.

Silence creates suspense because the human mind is uncomfortable with an absence of information. When background sound is removed, the viewer listens more carefully and becomes aware of every small noise. A sudden stop in ambience before a notification makes the next sound feel sharper and more threatening, and a long silence before the reveal makes the audience anticipate an event they cannot yet identify.

The sound of the notification is especially important. Because it is the same sound that many viewers hear every day, it links the fear of the film to the real world, and the audience begins to feel anxious about their own devices.

CHAPTER 14
EDITING TECHNIQUES

Editing determines the timing of suspense and the way information reaches the audience. In VISUAL ANOMALY, the editing is designed to keep the hallucination believable until the final moment.

- **Jump cuts:** used briefly to show the passing of anxious time and to disturb the sense of continuity as her mental state weakens.
- **Match cuts:** used to connect similar movements or shapes, such as her looking towards the window and then towards the bedroom corner, so that the space feels controlled by an unseen force.
- **Text overlays:** the frightening messages appear as clean on-screen text with precise timing.
- **Notification graphics:** designed to look like a genuine phone interface so that the audience accepts them as real.
- **Color grading:** warm tones at the start and cooler, desaturated tones in the later scenes.
- **Reaction cuts:** quick cuts to her face immediately after each message to record fear.
- **Fade to black:** used at the end to hold the shock and introduce the final quote.
- **Timing of suspense:** shots are held slightly longer than expected before each message to increase anticipation.

The hallucination must appear believable because the film depends on the audience trusting the protagonist. If the notifications look artificial, the viewer will suspect the twist early and the impact will be reduced. Realistic fonts, natural timing and a consistent screen design ensure that the false messages are treated as facts. The ending is powerful only when the audience feels that it has been deceived by its own perception.

CHAPTER 15
USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The film is produced in a small apartment setting, and the choice of location is closely connected to the theme. The production uses three areas of the same space.

- **Living room:** the place of arrival, comfort and the first messages.
- **Bedroom:** the place of the final fear and the reveal.
- **Apartment:** the overall environment that suggests isolation and privacy.

The props are simple objects found in an ordinary home. Each one is used for a specific purpose.

- **Mobile phone:** the central object and the source of the deception.
- **Curtains:** a symbol of the boundary between private space and the outside world.
- **Bed:** a place of safety that becomes a place of fear.
- **Sofa:** a symbol of relaxation at the beginning.
- **Lights:** used to control mood and to show the character's actions.
- **Door:** shows arrival and reminds the audience that the apartment is closed.
- **Handbag:** establishes that she has just returned from work.
- **House keys:** indicate that she is alone and that the space is secured.

Minimal props increase realism because the audience is not distracted by unnecessary objects. When the space is simple, every item has meaning and the viewer's attention remains on the character and the emotion. A home that looks natural also makes the frightening events feel more believable, since the audience can imagine the same place in their own lives.

CHAPTER 16
RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

The story of VISUAL ANOMALY can be adapted for radio by removing the dependence on images and replacing visual information with sound. In a podcast, the listener cannot see the phone, the curtains or the bedroom, and the audio must therefore create these images in the imagination.

The adaptation follows a simple principle: whatever the camera shows must be communicated by narration, sound effects, voice performance or silence. The major changes are described below.

- Notifications become a phone vibration and a short chime, followed by the narrator reading the message in a distinct voice.
- The curtains become the sound of fabric being pulled across a rail, so that the listener understands the action without being told.
- Looking left becomes a sudden breath, a soft turn of the head and a short narration describing the movement.
- The phone reveal becomes the sound of an object sliding along the floor beneath the bed, followed by a moment of silence.

Radio has certain advantages in a story about perception. Since the audience cannot see, they are forced to trust what they hear, which parallels the woman’s dependence on the messages. The hallucination can therefore be presented even more convincingly in audio, because there is no visual evidence to contradict it.

However, the adaptation also has limitations. The reveal of the phone, which is a strong visual moment in the film, must be created through sound and a carefully timed line from the narrator

or the character. This demonstrates the difference between visual and audio storytelling and the need to choose techniques according to the medium.

CHAPTER 17
RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast script is planned scene by scene so that each part of the story has a clear sound identity. The audio version uses a narrator, a female protagonist, notification sounds and carefully controlled silence.

- **Narrator:** describes actions and places, guides the listener and sets the mood. The narrator's voice remains calm and controlled so that the fear develops gradually.
- **Female protagonist:** speaks her thoughts, such as "Who knows I just got home?", and reacts through breathing and short spoken lines.
- **Notification sounds:** introduced before each message to make the listener expect the next event.
- **Silence:** placed before important lines to increase tension.
- **Final reveal:** expressed through dialogue and sound rather than description.

The episode begins with the sound of a door, keys and a light switch while the narrator describes the woman coming home. The first notification is marked by a vibration and read in a whispered, slightly echoing voice. The curtain sequence combines the sound of fabric with the second message, and the bedroom scene uses closer breathing and a low ambient tone.

In the final section, each message is separated by a longer silence. When she kneels, the narration stops and only her breathing and a faint heartbeat remain. The reveal is delivered through a short line from the protagonist, such as "It's my phone… it was here all along," followed by the sound of the object sliding on the floor. The closing quote is read slowly by the narrator, and the podcast ends with complete silence.

CHAPTER 18
VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice performance is the main tool of the podcast version, since the emotional story must be communicated without images. The performance should therefore be planned as carefully as the acting in the film.

- **Calm voice:** the character's voice at the beginning is relaxed and tired but natural.
- **Nervous breathing:** gradually introduced to show anxiety before the first message and increased during the bedroom sequence.
- **Whispered thoughts:** used for internal questions to give the listener a sense of privacy and fear.
- **Emotional progression:** the voice moves from calm to confused, then frightened and finally shocked.
- **Voice modulation:** changes of pitch, speed and volume that reflect the intensity of each moment.
- **Echo for hallucinated messages:** an echo or slight reverb makes the messages sound unreal and separates them from the ordinary world.

The narrator and the protagonist should have clearly different voices. The narrator should sound steady and measured, providing a stable background against which the protagonist's fear can be heard. The hallucinated messages should be delivered in a flat and neutral tone, because emotionless delivery is more unsettling than a threatening one.

Recording should be done in a quiet room with a microphone placed close to the speaker and a pop filter if available. Clean recording allows subtle sounds such as breathing and whispering to be heard clearly. In post-production, equalisation, mild noise reduction and reverb are applied so that the voices sit naturally with the sound effects and the ambience.

CHAPTER 19
PRODUCTION PROCESS

The project follows the three usual stages of media production: pre-production, production and post-production.

Pre-production

- **Story:** the idea was developed into a complete story and a short screenplay suited to a running time of 2 minutes 15 seconds.
- **Storyboard:** each scene was drawn or described in sequence to plan the framing and the timing of the messages.
- **Shot list:** a list of the required shots, angles and camera movements was prepared to make the filming organised and efficient.

Production

- **Filming:** the scenes are recorded in the living room and bedroom according to the shot list, with several takes for each key moment.
- **Camera setup:** a camera or smartphone mounted on a tripod is used, with attention to height, angle and stable framing.
- **Acting:** the performance is directed so that the woman's emotions change gradually and believably, and her reactions are recorded separately for editing.

Post-production

- **Editing:** the shots are arranged, timed and trimmed, and the notification graphics are added.
- **Sound:** the effects, ambience, breathing and silence are recorded, edited and mixed.
- **Color grading:** the film is adjusted from warm to cool tones to match the story.
- **Export:** the final version is checked for continuity and synchronisation and exported in a suitable format.

Careful planning at each stage reduces errors and saves time, especially in a small production with few resources.

CHAPTER 20
CHALLENGES FACED

Producing a psychological thriller with limited resources involved several practical and creative challenges.

- **Shooting alone:** managing the camera, the performance and the lighting together required careful planning, repeated test shots and the use of a tripod and self-monitoring.
- **Creating believable hallucinations:** the messages had to look like real notifications, and their design and placement needed several revisions.
- **Timing notifications:** the appearance of each message had to match the actor's reaction, the sound of the notification and the edit. Small delays reduced the tension.
- **Maintaining continuity:** since a scene was shot in parts, the position of the curtains, lights and props had to remain consistent across shots.
- **Lighting indoors:** a small apartment has limited space and mixed light sources, so it was difficult to create dramatic shadows without overexposure.
- **Recording clean audio:** noise from fans, traffic and the room affected the recordings, and several takes were needed for breathing and whispers.

Each challenge was addressed through preparation and practice. Test recordings, a detailed shot list and a checklist for props and lighting reduced errors, and the process showed that problem solving is as important as creativity in film production. These experiences also gave a realistic picture of the constraints faced by independent filmmakers.

CHAPTER 21
LEARNING OUTCOMES

The project has provided practical experience in almost every stage of media production and has developed both technical and creative skills.

- **Screenwriting:** learning to tell a complete story with a clear structure in a very short time.
- **Directing:** planning scenes, guiding performance and making decisions about mood.
- **Acting:** understanding how small expressions and controlled breathing can communicate fear.
- **Camera composition:** using framing, distance and movement to shape audience emotion.
- **Sound design:** building tension through effects, ambience and silence.
- **Editing:** controlling timing, continuity and the placement of graphics.
- **Psychological storytelling:** presenting an inner experience through external images and sounds.

The project also taught the importance of timing. A single second of silence or a small delay before a message can create more suspense than a complex effect. Understanding this principle is valuable for every kind of media production.

The radio adaptation added experience in narration, voice acting and audio editing. It made clear that the same story must be told differently in different media, and that a filmmaker has to think about the audience's experience rather than only the technique. Working on hallucination and fear also encouraged a thoughtful and respectful understanding of mental health themes.

CHAPTER 22
EXPECTED OUTCOME

The expected outcome of the project is a short psychological thriller film titled VISUAL ANOMALY, with a running time of two minutes fifteen seconds, together with a radio podcast adaptation of the same story. The film should demonstrate the practical use of visual storytelling, sound design and editing to create a strong emotional response.

The audience is expected to experience a sequence of emotions as the story develops:

- **Curiosity:** about the source of the first message.
- **Anxiety:** as the messages show knowledge of her actions.
- **Suspense:** during the bedroom sequence and the instruction to look under the bed.
- **Shock:** at the discovery of the phone and the realisation that the fear was imagined.
- **Reflection:** on how the mind can create fear and how mental health affects perception.

The final reflection is the most important goal. After the shock has passed, viewers should consider how anxiety and isolation can affect a person's understanding of reality. The film does not try to explain mental illness but invites the audience to recognise that fear can feel completely real, even when there is no external cause.

The project is also expected to demonstrate the technical ability of the student. The final product should show clear framing, controlled lighting, careful sound design and precise editing, and the podcast should show effective voice work and the imaginative use of audio. Together, these outcomes show how a simple idea can be transformed into a memorable piece of media.

CHAPTER 23
CONCLUSION

VISUAL ANOMALY demonstrates how a simple story can be developed into an effective psychological thriller through the careful use of film-making techniques. The story begins with an ordinary return home and gradually introduces suspense through a series of mysterious notifications. By the end, the audience discovers that the entire threat has been created by the protagonist's own mind.

The project combines screenplay writing, direction, acting, cinematography, lighting, sound design and editing. Each element supports the central theme of hallucination and distorted reality. The single location, the small number of props and the absence of a visible antagonist show that an effective short film does not require complex resources, only a clear idea and thoughtful execution.

The radio podcast adaptation further shows how storytelling can move from a visual medium to an audio medium. The elements that are seen in the film must be communicated through narration, voice performance, sound effects and silence. This adaptation strengthens the understanding of how audiences imagine stories and how creators can guide that imagination.

Overall, the project has provided valuable practical experience in film making and radio podcasting. It has also shown the importance of creativity, timing and audience awareness in media production, and it has encouraged a deeper consideration of how fear and perception influence human experience.

"The scariest prison is the one your mind builds."

"The phone was never there. The fear always was."